Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 5
♥ 7
♦ Q 10 6 5 3
♣ K 10 8 4

♠ J 8 4 3
♥ 10 9 8 5 3 2
♦ 2
♣ 7 5

♠ Q 10 9 7 2
♥ A Q J 6
♦ A 8
♣ 6 3

♠ 6
♥ K 4
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ A Q J 9 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♦ by South
Lead: ♣7

SOUTH thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are missing two Aces!

Board 2
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A Q J 7 3 ♥ A J 8 6 ♦ 5 3 ♣ 8 7	
♠ 10 9 6 ♥ 7 2 ♦ Q 9 8 4 ♣ K Q 10 2		♠ 8 5 2 ♥ 4 3 ♦ K J 10 2 ♣ J 9 6 3
	♠ K 4 ♥ K Q 10 9 5 ♦ A 7 6 ♣ A 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by South
Lead: ♣K

SOUTH knows NORTH has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, NORTH comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces SOUTH knows there are not enough points for Grand, so she bids 6♥.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 6 2 ♥ K Q J 7 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J 10 9	
♠ Q J 10 9 ♥ 6 4 ♦ Q 8 5 3 ♣ 8 5 3		♠ 8 7 4 ♥ 8 3 ♦ K J 10 7 2 ♣ 7 6 2
	♠ K 5 3 ♥ A 10 9 5 2 ♦ A 9 4 ♣ A 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5NT[3]
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace
3. asks for kings

7♥ by South
Lead: ♠Q

When NORTH answers Blackwood with one Ace SOUTH decides to bid 5NT to ask for Kings.

With two Kings, NORTH would bid 6♥. But she knows that if she does so, SOUTH might stop right there.

Knowing the 5NT bid guarantees all four Aces, NORTH figures her ♣ suit will supply five tricks so she bids 7♥.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 8 7 ♥ Q 9 7 4 ♦ K Q 5 ♣ A 10 8 3	
♠ 9 4 3 ♥ K 3 ♦ J 10 9 8 2 ♣ 9 6 2	N W E S	♠ J 10 6 2 ♥ 10 8 ♦ A 7 4 3 ♣ 7 5 4
	♠ A K Q 5 ♥ A J 6 5 2 ♦ 6 ♣ K Q J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by South
Lead: ♣2

SOUTH thinks there might be slam if NORTH holds both minor Aces, so he tries Blackwood.

When NORTH shows just one Ace SOUTH is afraid he will have a trump loser as well, so he stops at 5♥.

It turns out that SOUTH might make twelve tricks, depending on the ♥K situation.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K 4 2 ♥ A Q J 8 7 4 2 ♦ K ♣ K 3	
♠ Q 10 9 8 ♥ 10 9 ♦ J 8 7 4 ♣ J 6 5		♠ 7 5 3 ♥ 6 3 ♦ 10 9 5 3 ♣ Q 10 8 2
	♠ A J 6 ♥ K 5 ♦ A Q 6 2 ♣ A 9 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♣[2]	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces

7NT by South
Lead: ♠10

NORTH might be tempted to blast into Blackwood with his first bid, pushing toward some slam in ♥s. He chooses to temporize with a 1♥ response and is rewarded when SOUTH jumps to 2NT (18-19 points).

The Notrump bid prevents NORTH from using Blackwood, but Gerber 4♣ will work just fine. When he discovers that SOUTH holds three Aces and one King he can count thirteen tricks.

Board 6
North Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ A K ♥ K Q 4 ♦ K Q J 3 ♣ K Q J 5	
♠ J 9 4 ♥ 9 8 5 3 2 ♦ A 8 7 ♣ 9 2	N W E S	♠ 10 8 7 5 2 ♥ J 6 ♦ 10 6 4 ♣ 7 4 3
	♠ Q 6 3 ♥ A 10 7 ♦ 9 5 2 ♣ A 10 8 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♥8

SOUTH responds 2NT, showing 8+ points with no 5-card suit.

NORTH only needs to know how many Aces are in the SOUTH hand. He must use Gerber since 4NT in this situation would not be Blackwood.

When SOUTH shows two Aces NORTH bids 6NT.